



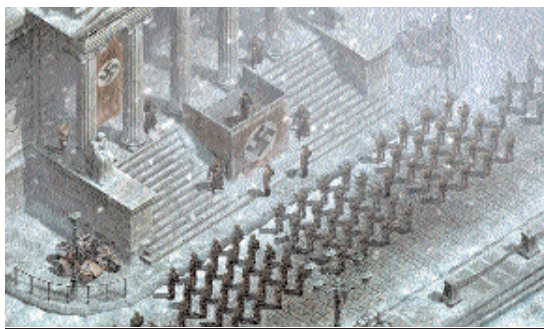
Commandos 3: Destination Berlin

Revamped and much more intense

Difficulty-wise, *Commandos 3*, fits somewhere between the first two versions. Its interface has been revamped from the original cluttered backpack. All other functions are neatly categorised into five hexagonal buttons displayed at the bottom of the screen. Two of these provide access to your weapons and items. Right-clicking on them expands the buttons to show all usable equipment.

This rearrangement looks very good, but veterans don't really bother with the interface—they will use the hotkeys instead. But, except for three or four critical hotkeys, the rest have been done away with.

C3 has more intensity in it than *C1* and *C2* combined. Several missions have very limited time to accomplish the objectives. In the opening mission, your sniper needs to take out the elite German sniper, before



The Fuhrer addressing his Nazi legions

he kills off the Russian soldiers. In one mission, the night before D-Day, you need to disable the reinforcements stationed in a camp, within 10 minutes, before they head for the beaches of Normandy.

The missions in *C3* have undergone a sea change. The total game time has been halved.

The sound in *C3* is, excellent. The graphic engine now gives you the ability to zoom and rotate smoothly around your character even while indoors.

Another facet of the game that's been done well is the characters that populate it. The fluff of the previous titles has been discarded.

Unit skills have also been upgraded. Commandos can now carry soldiers around. All units can now stun soldiers and tie them up. The only exception to this is the weakling Spy, who still has to rely on his hypo injections to knock people out.

C3 carries both good and bad things. The game is relatively short, and there are a few glitches. But, as long as we get our yearly dose of some great Nazi lovin', we'll still be playing *Commandos 3*.

Genre: Action ■ **Developer:** Pyro Studios ■ **Publisher:** Eidos Interactive

System requirements: 700 MHz CPU, 256 MB RAM, GeForce or Radeon-class card with 32 MB memory, 2 GB free disk space

Price: Rs 2,999 ■ **Web site:** www.commandosgame.com



Need for Speed Underground

Too Fast

The first thing that *NFS Underground* reminds you of is *2 Fast 2 Furious*, the movie that inspired millions to get their crummy cars upgrades and loud gangsta rap. The car racing scenes in the movie were mind blowing. Here is a game that promises the same fun.

Additions to this version of *NFS* are the Drag and Drift modes. And the competition is great. The PC puts up a good fight, and rival cars use all available shortcuts. To be on top, take all the shortcuts and drive like the devil.

The handling of cars is by far the best in this version. You start off with standard cars, all fresh out of the factory — models with handling and speed that are not the best. But as you progress and upgrade the car, its handling improves, and so does the speed. But performance upgrades are not the only things you can

do with the cars. It is also very crucial that you car looks good. You can get style points and multipliers that unlock vinyls and other goodies that add to the look of your baby.

The music list for *NFSU* comprises punk and gangsta rap. You will enjoy this too till the end of the starry-eyed effect. It would have been awesome if they'd allowed us to play MP3s from our hard drive.

The motion blur is awesome. It makes you actually feel the speed. But there's no motion blur on older cards like the GeForce2 or the Radeon 8500. You need NOS to experience it. There is a small program available online to the game work on LANs. The LAN gaming thing is very sim-



A slow-mo sequence depicting the downfall of your ride

ilar to the online one, and it's fun.

The game could have been awesome, but there only 15 race tracks. Would I buy it? Yeah. For the simple reason that EA has promised a LAN gaming patch and the online thing.

Genre: Action ■ **Developer:** Electronic Arts ■ **Publisher:** Electronic Arts ■ **System requirements:** 800 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, GeForce2-class card, 1 GB hard disk space ■ **Web site:** www.needforspeed.com ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★